

You said it...



I have a few comments on the new features of SVN 1.6.

I'd be really interested to know if SVN now tracks the file history across a simple rename—something that is likely to be of far more universal interest than an actual conflict. In any case, Git (and possibly other VCSs) seem to do just the right thing even when there is a conflict rename/modify conflict such as the one described, and usually without user input.

On the security aspect, authentication is no longer something that a normal 'application' should deal with; delegating it to tried and tested mechanisms like SSH and public key authentication is the only sensible option. The question is not how the application stores the password but why the application should even have to worry about this. Not all applications can piggyback on SSH, but I see no reason why SVN could not have done so.

Finally, I also wonder why it is not possible to unpack a 'packed' repository—one-way operations in a code repository are somewhat disconcerting, to say the least. Is it merely that no one has written an unpacker (which is OK) or that it is actually impossible (which sounds like the pack format is fragile in some way)? I certainly hope it is the former.

I certainly don't agree with Linus Torvalds' (in)famous statement that, "SVN is the most pointless project ever started." I regard SVN as walking the minefield, so the ones that follow know what to avoid, and that is worthy of our respect and gratitude.

But I also feel (and I have said this before) that continuing on a project that started out as "CVS done right" is not an optimal use of the enormous talent and brains that are behind SVN. CVS is more than 18 years old now, and the time for fixing its problems is long gone. The right thing to do is to give it an honourable retirement and let the new crop take over.

—**Sitaram Chamarty, sitaramc@gmail.com**



I read the article about 'FOSSconf 2009' in the April 2009. I wish to share a few more things that happened:

1. Most FOSS lovers visited the conference without thinking about time and distance. A few people came from Bangalore, Hyderabad, etc. One man from Canada came to this event and visited all demo stalls, enquiring a lot about the localisation of Linux.
2. Students from TVS Matriculation, in the age group of around 12 years, really rocked the demo stalls.
3. The Chennai LUG members issued cash gifts of Rs 10,000 each to the best demo stall, best project and best new student speaker to encourage the students in FOSS activities.

I was there at the demo stall of the Ubuntu Tamil team.

—**Padhu, Pollachi**



The April issue was very good, especially the article on how Dell could eat up Apple's market share. As for Debian Lenny, I am dying to get the other four DVDs. I've started reading your magazine since last year and I'm in love with the magazine now. The articles on Python are really good.

A small request: please include an article on Network Simulator 2 and 3. It would be very helpful for network designers like me. Also, I would really appreciate it if the magazine bundled distros like Linux Mint and Linuxos in the forthcoming issues. And, by the way, keep up the good work!

—**Nitish, nitishbangera@yahoo.co.in**

ED: Wow! Thanks for your compliments. We'll certainly try our best to include articles on network simulators in the upcoming issues. As for your request to bundle Linux Mint and Linuxos (I guess you meant Linspire, which is now Freespire?) I've conveyed your message to the CD team.



I was really upset after seeing www.linbai.info/magazine/linux-for-you-magazine-march-2009.html. Note that the link might change but the soft copy of *LFY* is available for download in that website, which was previously called www.ebookpedia.info.

I hate to see my all time favourites, like *LFY*, coming out as e-books, scanned by some reader. *LFY* folks—please do the needful. Is the e-book publishing plan required for *LFY*?

—**Gouri Ananth, ananth.gouri@gmail.com**

ED: Well, this is certainly interesting. There's nothing much we can do as most of the content in the magazine is released under the Creative Commons-Attribution-ShareAlike 3.0 Unported License after a month from the date of publication. Anyway, work is on at LinuxForU.com and the site should be up by the end of May, if things go as per plan. Once it goes live, we'll slowly start feeding in the magazine archives. Please don't expect every issue at once—May '09 will be our 76th issue. Anyway, we'll certainly welcome all those who're interested in reading the PDFs, to come and check out all our archives. Our licensing permits everyone to use most of our articles in any way, as long as they give attribution, and release the modified content under the same licence. :-) We only hope, a Web interface makes this easier.

Errata

In our April '09 issue, on the Contents page, the description of OpenSolaris was wrongly repeated against Debian Lenny too. We regret this error.

Please send your comments or suggestions to:

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